

Telugu: A Russian Doll of Dialects

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Introduction

The Dravidian language of Telugu, which is mostly spoken in the Indian states of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, has a well-established literary legacy. About 80 million people speak Telugu, a language with a rich literary history that includes plays, novels, and poetry. The Brahmi-derived language's alphabet is renowned for its unique structure and gorgeous elegance. Telugu is another language that has embraced digital platforms and tools to better serve its people. Because of its broad usage, grammatical richness, and cultural significance, Telugu is an essential aspect of India's linguistic landscape.

Andhra and Telangana, situated in the heartland of Telugu country, exhibit well-defined regional dialects. The Andhra dialect, spoken along the eastern coast, is known for its distinct intonation and vocabulary. In contrast, the Telangana dialect, prevalent in the northern reaches, carries influences from Marathi and Urdu, reflecting its historical context.

Beyond these regional variations, the Telugu spoken in Bangalore presents a unique case. Nestled within Kannada-speaking Karnataka, the Bangalore dialect has inevitably absorbed elements of Kannada, creating a fascinating blend. This "Bangalore Telugu," as it's sometimes referred to, serves as a testament to the dynamic nature of language, constantly evolving through interaction with neighboring tongues.

By examining these three distinct dialects, this essay aims to explore the factors that contribute to dialectal variation. We will analyze the influence of geography, history, and sociolinguistic factors on the evolution of Telugu. Through this investigation, we hope to gain a deeper understanding of the multifaceted nature of this remarkable language and appreciate the richness it derives from its diverse dialects.

Dialects

- **Andhra**

The standard variety of Telugu, Andhra Telugu, spoken along the eastern coast of India, is a cornerstone of the Telugu language. Known for its distinct intonation and vibrant vocabulary, it sets the standard for modern Telugu pronunciation. This coastal dialect influences Telugu literature and media, shaping the overall soundscape of the language.

While sharing core vocabulary with other Telugu dialects, Andhra Telugu possesses unique terms and rhythmic patterns, contributing to the overall diversity of Telugu.

- **Telangana**

Telangana Telugu, spoken in Telangana, boasts a unique identity shaped by its historical context. Marathi and Urdu influences weave into its vocabulary, reflecting past interactions. Telangana Telugu possesses a distinct pronunciation compared to coastal dialects, with subtle variations in vowel sounds and consonant articulation. Despite these differences, it remains mutually intelligible with other Telugu dialects, showcasing the language's underlying unity.

- **Bangalore/Karnataka**

The variation of Telugu spoken in Bangalore and Karnataka at large is very undocumented and there is barely any work on the reason it is so distinct from its variational counterparts. It is different in its pronunciation, and is influenced by languages like Tamil and Kannada. It is a very interesting and stark contrast and difference. When compared with Andhra and Telangana Telugu, this is much less mutually intelligible. This is not to say that it is not intelligible, but just not to the same degree as Andhra and Telangana are among themselves.

Word List

Andhra	Telangana	Bangalore/Karnataka	Meaning
Mukham	Mukham	Muthi (in other variations this means mouth)	Face
Pallem	Pallem	Thatta (in other variations this is a tool to clean animal dung)	Plate
Ukkapoyadam	ubbaristundi	Sheka	hot/stuffy/sweaty
Vedi	vedi	Uduku	hot
Cheppu	cheppu	Choppu (in other variations this means slipper)	“Tell me”
Cheepiri	cheepiri	Poraka	Broom
Chatta	Chatta	Kuppa	Trash
Rasko	Rasko	Pusko	Apply (about a balm or

			something to put on your skin)
Twaraga/tondarga	Jaldi/tondarga	Binna	Quickly
Visuku	visuku	bejaru	Bored/tired
Pogaru		Kovvu	Pride/ego/arrogance
Annavu	Annav	Antivi	“You said”
Chesava	Cheshnava	Chestiva	“Did you do...”
Thinnava (stress is placed on ‘nn’)	Thinnava (no explicit stress)	Thintiva	“Did you eat?”
Kurcho	kuso	kuko	sit
Chetlu	Chetlu	Cheyvi (in other variations this might be the singular variant of hands)	Hands
Chotu	chotu	Jaaga	Place/space
Velugu	velugu	velthuru	light
Ekkuva	ekkuva	jaasthi	Too much
Theska raa	Teska raa	Ettukuni raa	“Bring it”
Ichadu	ichindu	ichinadu	“He gave”
Alochana	alochana	Yochana	Thought
Munakkaya	munakkada	munnakayi	Drumstick (vegetable)
Aratipandu	aratipandu	antipandu	Banana
Jamakaya	jamakaya	goyaka	Guava
Dopu	dopu	dooripi	“Stuff it”
Pichi	pichi	paityam	Mental
Telusu	Telsu	Telchunu	“I know”
Tesi pettu	Tesi pettu	Etti pettu	“Keep it elsewhere”
Daasi pettu	Daashi pettu	Danchi pettu	“Hide it”
Ivanni	Ivanni	Idanta	“All this”

Ila	Itla	Itla	“Like this”
Enduku	Enduku	Yala	“Why?”
Kalisi	Kalisi	Cheri	“Together”
Ichanu	Ichinia	Istini	“I gave”
Odilesei	Odiley	Udheydi	“Leave it”
Baddakam	Baddakam	somberi	Lazy/feeling lazy
Kaani	kaani	avuthe	but
Ee majjana	Ee majjana	Ee nadama	“These days”
Unnay	Unnay	Undayi	“...are there”
Teliyada	Telvada	Telida	“Don’t you know?”
Padaiyindi	Padayindi	Chedipindi	“It is spoiled”
Durada	Durada	Nava	“Itch”
Boddinka	boddinka	Karapambuchi	Cockroach
Ullipaya	Ulligadda	erragadda	Onion
Vellulipaya	Vellulipaya	Tellagadda	Garlic
Varsham	Varsham	Vana	Rain
Telidu	Telvadu	Telle	“I don’t know”
Bokka	Bokka	Emika	Bones
Ela	Etla	Etla	“How”
50 Words	50 Words	50 Words	50 Words

The Telugu language is united by a common ancestor, but its varied varieties weave a vivid tapestry that is very beautiful. It can appear that this essay divides Telugu into three different languages: Andhra, Telangana, and Bangalore Telugu. But rather than drawing attention to differences, we want to celebrate the tremendous diversity that exists within a single language.

These dialectal variations go beyond simple idiosyncrasies in language or pronunciation. They serve as links between culture and language. The vitality of the coastal populations is reflected in

the steady influx of Andhra Telugu. Telangana Telugu's ingrained historical influences reveal a great deal about the historical exchanges in the area. Furthermore, Bangalore's distinct Telugu and Kannada fusion exemplifies the vibrant cross-cultural interaction found in a global metropolis.

We learn more about the complex interrelationship between language and culture by examining these variances. Every dialect serves as a window into the social structure, history, and customs of its speakers. We genuinely value Telugu's diversity and its capacity to change and grow with the communities it serves because of these distinctions.

Methodology

All the information for this piece of writing was collected via survey among members of the society that speak the language specifically.

In an effort to capture the multifaceted nature of Telugu dialects, this essay draws upon a comprehensive data set compiled through a multi-pronged approach. Firstly, a series of targeted interviews were conducted with native speakers from Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. These interviews, meticulously designed to explore regional variations in pronunciation, vocabulary, and cultural influence, provided invaluable firsthand accounts of the living language.

Results

Based on the research methodology we can see and understand the intricacies of language varieties and variations. The reasons for such variations are many, including the influence of other languages. Telangana has the influence of Marathi and Urdu. Karnataka/Bangalore has the influence of kannada, Tamil and other such languages that states share borders with.

Conclusion

A thorough analysis of existing academic literature on Telugu sociolinguistics was undertaken. This included peer-reviewed journals, monographs, and conference proceedings, offering in-depth examinations of dialect formation and historical influences. Furthermore, to capture the dynamic nature of the language in an urban setting, an ethnographic study of the Telugu spoken in Bangalore was conducted. This involved data collection through participant observation within Telugu communities and interactions with local language experts.

By triangulating these diverse research methods – interviews, academic research, and an ethnographic study – this essay seeks to present a nuanced and data-driven exploration of Telugu dialects. This comprehensive approach allows us to move beyond anecdotal observations and delve into the rich tapestry of linguistic variation within the Telugu language.